

Email Triage Assistant

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DSC670 GenAI Milestone 3

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Milestone 3 V1: Email Triage Assistant Baseline

Introduction

This document presents the baseline version (v1) of the Email Triage Assistant project developed for Microsoft Copilot. The goal is to build an intelligent agent that classifies incoming Outlook emails and provides concise, actionable summaries.

The v1 agent implements core triage functionality: it categorizes emails as High, Medium, or Low priority, generates concise summaries, and restricts actions to Outlook workflows only, explicitly excluding Teams and SharePoint.

This baseline approach provides fast, directional triage behavior suitable for initial validation and sets the foundation for future iterations.

Source Email Examples

The agent was tested against three representative email types to demonstrate its behavior across different scenarios:

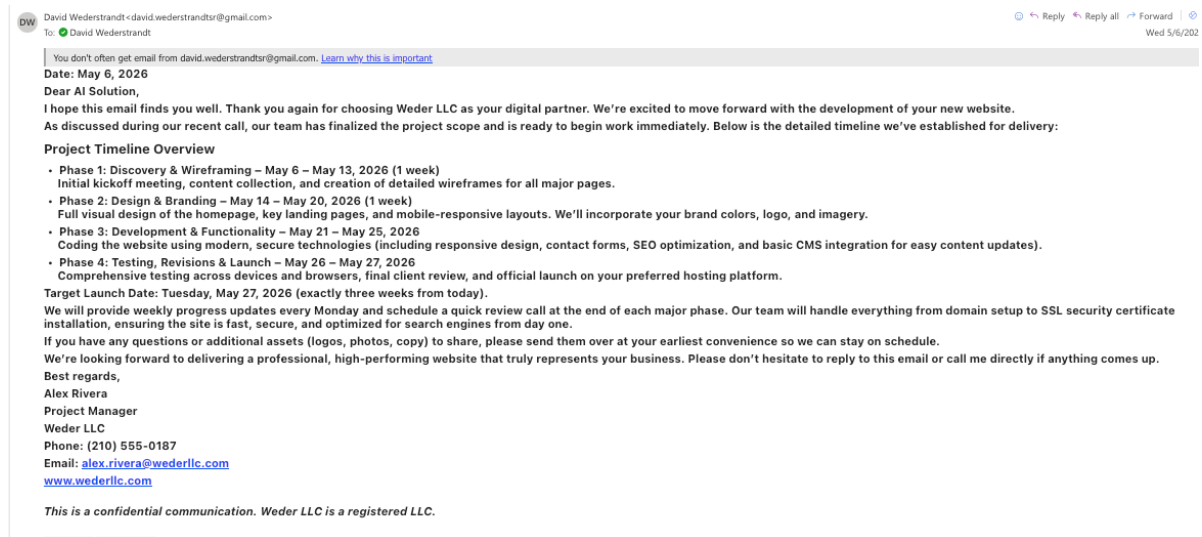


Figure 1. Weder LLC Project Coordination Email:

A detailed project timeline email from a web development partner outlining phases, deliverables, and deadlines. This test case demonstrates how the v1 agent handles complex project-related communications.

From: San Antonio Food Bank <communications@safoodbank.org>
Date: May 6, 2026 at 18:11:24 CDT
To: david.wederstrandtsr@gmail.com
Subject: Stamp Out Hunger is on Saturday! 🇺🇸 🍷
Reply-To: communications@safoodbank.org

Is this email not displaying correctly? [View it in your browser.](#)





SATURDAY, MAY 9, 2026

Stamp Out Hunger With Us!

The San Antonio Food Bank is proud to partner again with the National Association of Letter Carriers for [Stamp Out Hunger®](#), the largest single-day food drive in the country!

With the support of CPS Energy, Letter Carriers delivered plastic bags to 600,000 households in San Antonio and surrounding areas. **The NALC is encouraging households to fill the bag with non-perishable food and place it out by their mailbox on Saturday, May 9, 2026, by 7 AM.** Your local Letter Carrier will pick up your food donations as they deliver mail along their routes!

Step 1: Find the blue bag in your mailbox.	Step 2: Gather some non-perishable goods.	Step 3: Fill the bag and leave it out near your mailbox!
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Figure 2. Food Bank Stamp Out Hunger Reminder:

An informational email about a community food bank participation event. This example shows the agent's ability to triage optional community engagement requests.

From: Bellevue University Student Communication <Studentcommunication@buemail.bellevue.edu>
Sent: Tuesday, April 28, 2026 2:45 PM
To: dong lee <dolee@my365.bellevue.edu>
Subject: Bruin Bulletin for April 28



Figure 3. Bruin Bulletin Newsletter:

A university bulletin with campus announcements and events. This represents the newsletter category of emails that the agent must correctly classify as informational.

Agent V1: Email Priority Assistant

The v1 agent applies simple, fast triage logic to classify incoming emails. It assigns a priority label (High, Medium, or Low) and creates a summary without returning JSON or structured machine output.

Key constraints include Outlook-only actions and the Unclassified fallback for low-confidence outcomes. This baseline approach focuses on speed and clarity, making it easy to validate the core triage logic before adding complexity.

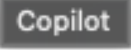
Outlook Summary Output (V1)

Solutions  Project Update: Web...

Priority: Medium

Summary:

- Sent by Alex Rivera, Project Manager at **Weder LLC**, confirming the website project is ready to begin. 
- Provides a **4-phase timeline** running **May 6–27, 2026**:
 - Discovery & Wireframing (May 6–13)
 - Design & Branding (May 14–20)
 - Development & Functionality (May 21–25)
 - Testing & Launch (May 26–27) 
- **Target launch date: Tuesday, May 27, 2026.** 
- Requests any remaining assets (logos, photos, copy) to stay on schedule. 

Action needed: 

- Review and acknowledge the timeline
- Send any outstanding assets
- Raise concerns now if dates need adjustment

Why this matters:

- This sets expectations, deadlines, and delivery dates for a live client project. No immediate urgency, but delays in assets could impact launch. 

If you want, I can **draft a quick approval reply, flag timeline risks, or turn this into a task checklist** for you.

Figure 4. Outlook Summary V1:

Figure 4 shows the baseline triage output with priority assignment, summary, and next-step recommendations. The output demonstrates the core v1 functionality in action.

The v1 output provides directional priority classification with a concise narrative summary. The structure is readable and useful for quick inbox triage, though the detail level and standardization are less refined than later iterations.

Food Bank Email Summary (V1)

Email Priority Assistant.
Here's a concise read-out of the email [Stamp Out Hunger is on Saturday!](#) and its priority: Stamp Out Hunqe...

Email Summary

- From the **San Antonio Food Bank**, forwarded to you.
- Reminder about **Stamp Out Hunger®**, the national one-day food drive.
- **When:** Saturday, May 9, 2026, by 7:00 AM.
- **What to do:**
 - Place non-perishable food in the blue bag left in your mailbox or any bag.
 - Leave it by your mailbox for your letter carrier to pick up.
- **Alternative:** Donate online (every \$1 = 10 pounds of food).

Priority Classification: Low

- Informational and community-focused.
- No action required unless you choose to participate.
- Time-sensitive only if you plan to donate today.

If you'd like, I can also **flag this**, **archive it**, or help you decide **what foods are best to donate** quickly.

Stamp Out Hunger is on Saturday! and its priority: Stamp Out Hunqe...

Sent on Wednesday 8:23 PM

David Wederstrandt to: You; David Wederstrandt

Stamp Out Hunger is on Saturday!

Message Copilot

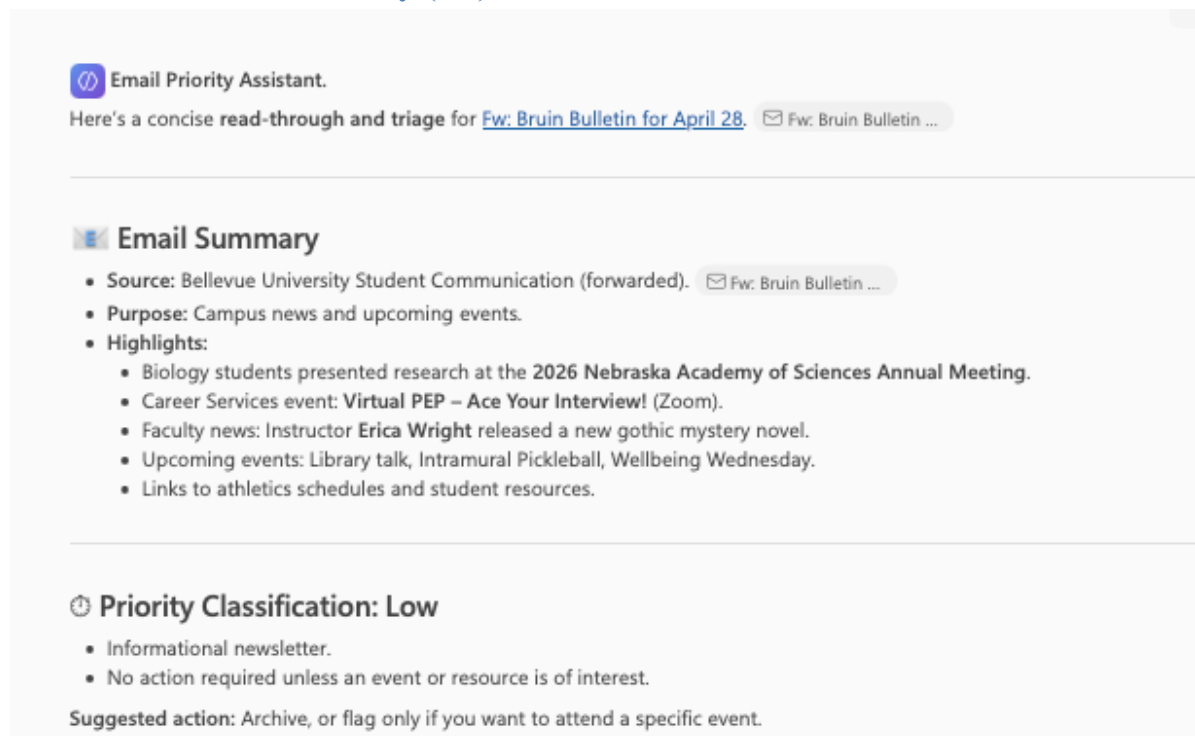
+ ×

Figure 5. Food Bank Summary V1:

Demonstrates v1 triage for informational/optional content. The agent correctly assigns a low priority to this type of email.

For optional, informational emails like the Food Bank reminder, v1 correctly assigns Low priority. The summary captures the event context with minimal but sufficient detail for quick decision-making.

Bruin Newsletter Summary (V1)



 **Email Priority Assistant.**
Here's a concise **read-through and triage** for [Fw: Bruin Bulletin for April 28](#).  Fw: Bruin Bulletin ...

 **Email Summary**

- **Source:** Bellevue University Student Communication (forwarded).  Fw: Bruin Bulletin ...
- **Purpose:** Campus news and upcoming events.
- **Highlights:**
 - Biology students presented research at the **2026 Nebraska Academy of Sciences Annual Meeting**.
 - Career Services event: **Virtual PEP – Ace Your Interview!** (Zoom).
 - Faculty news: Instructor **Erica Wright** released a new gothic mystery novel.
 - Upcoming events: Library talk, Intramural Pickleball, Wellbeing Wednesday.
 - Links to athletics schedules and student resources.

 **Priority Classification: Low**

- Informational newsletter.
- No action required unless an event or resource is of interest.

Suggested action: Archive, or flag only if you want to attend a specific event.

Figure 6. Bruin Newsletter Summary V1:

Figure 6 shows v1 treatment of newsletter-style content. The classification and summary capture the appropriate low-priority categorization for this email type.

Newsletter content is correctly treated as Low priority. The v1 agent concisely highlights key items, though the output structure lacks the standardization and depth that future versions provide.

Conclusion

The v1 agent successfully establishes baseline email triage functionality within Outlook workflows. Classification logic is sound, and the output is readable and actionable for quick inbox decisions.

Testing against three representative email types—a project coordination email, a community event reminder, and a university newsletter—demonstrates consistent and correct priority assignment. The Weder LLC project email was appropriately categorized as requiring action coordination, while both the food bank reminder and Bruin bulletin were correctly identified as low-priority informational content.

The core v1 design successfully implements the fundamental triage workflow: receiving an email, classifying its priority level, generating a concise summary, and suggesting next steps. By restricting actions to Outlook and excluding Teams and SharePoint, the agent maintains focus on a single, well-defined channel for email delivery and collaboration.

However, the v1 iteration reveals important limitations that guide future development. The output structure varies slightly across email types, making it harder to apply consistent patterns across a large inbox. The depth of reasoning provided for priority assignment is minimal, and the reply draft suggestions are basic. Confidence handling is not explicitly tracked, and there is no formal fallback mechanism for ambiguous or low-signal emails.

These gaps are not failures but rather natural starting points for refinement. The v1 baseline provides a solid foundation for more sophisticated triage capabilities. Future iterations will add structured output sections, explicit confidence tracking, richer decision rationales, and more professional reply guidance.

Next Steps

- Expand the instruction set to include explicit classification rules and confidence policy.
- Introduce structured output sections (Priority, Confidence, Summary, Next Steps, Reply Draft, Reason for Priority).
- Add guardrails to prevent the fabrication of facts and clarify how to handle uncertain or missing context.
- Validate improved consistency and depth against the same test email set.